Giung Nam

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1 Education

Ph.D., Kim Jaechul Graduate School of AI, KAIST, Sep 2022 to Feb 2026.
- Thesis: *Exploiting prior knowledge in pre-trained models*,
- Committee: Juho Lee (Advisor), Eunho Yang, Jong Chul Ye, Sehoon Kim, Se-Young Yun,
- GPA: 4.24/4.30.

M.S., Kim Jaechul Graduate School of AI, KAIST, Sep 2020 to Aug 2022.
- Thesis: *Diversity matters when learning from ensembles*,
- Committee: Juho Lee (Advisor), Eunho Yang, Sung Ju Hwang,
- GPA: 4.20/4.30.

B.S., Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Korea University, Mar 2017 to Aug 2020.
- GPA: 4.32/4.50.

2 Position

Postdoc., Information & Electronics Research Institute, KAIST, Mar 2026 to Feb 2027 (expected).

Research Intern, Visual Intelligence Laboratory, ETRI, Summer and Winter 2019, and Summer 2020.

3 Honors

Kim Younghan Global Leader Fellowship, Awarded from KAIST on Jul 24, 2023, for outstanding academic excellence, research capabilities, and leadership qualities.

Director General's Award, Awarded from NIMS on Dec 31, 2021, for dedication to the development of an artificial intelligence-based emulator for physics processes in numerical models.

4 Research Interests

My research is grounded in the philosophy that *today's posterior is tomorrow's prior*. I treat pre-trained models as foundational *priors* and investigate how to effectively transfer, adapt, and compress their knowledge into specialized *posteriors* that are more capable, cost-efficient, and personally tailored.

Contextual Specialization: Developing compact, specialized models via surgical ablation of redundant global knowledge while preserving task-specific reasoning and agentic capabilities.

Efficient Knowledge Adaptation: Transforming general priors into contextualized posteriors via sequential Bayesian updating and distillation for resource-efficient and sustainable deployment.

Self-Evolving and Robust Reasoning: Enhancing model intelligence via self-play and feedback-guided alignment with context-aware guardrails for secure human-AI collaboration.

5 Academic Activities

Area Chair, ICLR 2027.

Reviewer, ICML 2022-2026 (recieved Gold Reviewer recognition at 2026), NeurIPS 2022-2026 (recieved Top Reviewer recognition at 2022, 2023, and 2024), ICLR 2024-2026, IJCAI 2024, AAAI 2025 and 2027, AISTATS 2025-2027, and TMLR 2025-2026.

Teaching Assistant, Assisted courses at KAIST AI: *Deep Learning* (Instructor: Jaesik Choi; Fall 2020), *Machine Learning for AI* (Instructor: Juho Lee; Spring 2021), and *Bayesian Machine Learning* (Instructor: Juho Lee; Fall 2021).

Presentation, Presented papers at NeurIPS 2021 (online; Dec 2021), KAIST AI Workshop 21/22 (Daejeon, Republic of Korea; Jan 2022), ICML 2022 (online; Jul 2022), ICLR 2023 (Kigali, Rwanda; May 2023), ICML 2023 (Honolulu, United States; Jul 2023), Samsung Electronics DS Division (Hwasung, Republic of Korea; Aug 2023), AI SEOUL 2024 (Seoul, Republic of Korea; Feb 2024), ICLR 2024 (Vienna, Austria; May 2024), NeurIPS 2024 (Vancouver, Canada; Dec 2024), ICLR 2025 (Singapore; Apr 2025), ICML 2025 (Vancouver, Canada; Jul 2025), NeurIPS 2025 (San Diego, United States; Dec 2025), Global AI Frontier Lab 2026 Workshop (Seoul, Republic of Korea; Jun 2026 and Jul 2026), and Institute of Statistics at Korea University (Seoul, Republic of Korea; Oct 2026).

6 Publications (∗: co-first, †: co-corresponding)

6.1 International Journals

1. Hwan-Jin Song, Soonyoung Roh, Juho Lee, Giung Nam, Eunggu Yun, Jongmin Yoon, and Park Sa Kim. *"Benefits of stochastic weight averaging in developing neural network radiation scheme for numerical weather prediction"*. **Journal of Advances in Modeling Earth Systems**, Oct 2022.

6.2 International Conferences

16. Moonseok Choi, Jongwon Jeong, Minki Kang, Giung Nam†, and Juho Lee†. *"SKIM: pruning large language model agents via selective knowledge informed masking"*. **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)**, Dec 2026 (To appear).

15. Seungyoo Lee, Giung Nam, Seanie Lee, Hyungi Lee, and Juho Lee. *"SAVE: sparsity-aware influence estimation for vocabulary-expanded LLMs"*. **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)**, Dec 2026 (To appear).

14. Younghwan Kil, Giung Nam, Joonhyeong Park, Jinwoo Shin, and Juho Lee. *"Example-based spatial guidance for training-free concept erasure in diffusion models"*. **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)**, Dec 2026 (To appear).

13. Seungyoo Lee, Giung Nam, Hyungi Lee†, and Juho Lee†. *"OCNR: stabilizing self-play by mitigating iteration-collapse with one-class novelty rewards"*. **International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)**, Jul 2026.

12. Seungyoo Lee, Giung Nam, Moonseok Choi, Hyungi Lee†, and Juho Lee†. *"PANGEA: projection-based augmentation with non-relevant general data for enhanced domain adaptation in LLMs"*. **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)**, Dec 2025.

11. Jonggeon Park*, Giung Nam*, Hyunsu Kim, Jongmin Yoon, and Juho Lee. *"Ensemble distribution distillation via flow matching"*. **International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)**, Jul 2025.
10. Hyunsu Kim, Giung Nam, Chulhee Yun, Hongseok Yang, and Juho Lee. *"Parameter expanded stochastic gradient markov chain monte carlo"*. **International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)**, Apr 2025.
9. Giung Nam, and Juho Lee. *"Ex uno pluria: insights on ensembling in low precision number systems"*. **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)**, Dec 2024.
8. Moonseok Choi*, Hyungi Lee*, Giung Nam*, and Juho Lee. *"Sparse weight averaging with multiple particles for iterative magnitude pruning"*. **International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)**, May 2024.
7. Hyungi Lee*, Giung Nam*, Edwin Fong, and Juho Lee. *"Enhancing transfer learning with flexible nonparametric posterior sampling"*. **International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)**, May 2024.
6. Giung Nam, Byengho Heo, and Juho Lee. *"Lipsum-FT: robust fine-tuning of zero-shot models using random text guidance"*. **International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)**, May 2024.
5. Eunggu Yun*, Hyungi Lee*, Giung Nam*, and Juho Lee. *"Traversing between modes in function space for fast ensembling"*. **International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)**, Jul 2023.
4. Hyungi Lee, Eunggu Yun, Giung Nam, Edwin Fong, and Juho Lee. *"Martingale posterior neural processes"*. **International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), Spotlight**, May 2023.
3. Giung Nam*, Sunguk Jang*, and Juho Lee. *"Decoupled training for long-tailed classification with stochastic representations"*. **International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)**, May 2023.
2. Giung Nam, Hyungi Lee, Byeongho Heo, and Juho Lee. *"Improving ensemble distillation with weight averaging and diversifying perturbation"*. **International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)**, Jul 2022.
1. Giung Nam*, Jongmin Yoon*, Yoonho Lee, and Juho Lee. *"Diversity matters when learning from ensembles"*. **Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)**, Dec 2021.

6.3 Workshop Contributions

2. Younghwan Kil, Joonhyeong Park, Giung Nam, and Juho Lee. *"ASCG: adaptive spatial classifier guidance for surgical concept suppression in diffusion models"*. **The Second Edition of Workshop on Synthetic & Adversarial ForEnsics (SAFE@CVPR 2026)**, Jun 2026.
1. Sooyeon Kim, Giung Nam, Byoungwoo Park, and Juho Lee. *"Improving constrained language generation via self-distilled twisted sequential Monte Carlo"*. **The Second Edition of Frontiers in Probabilistic Inference: Learning meets Sampling (FPI@NeurIPS 2025)**, Dec 2025.